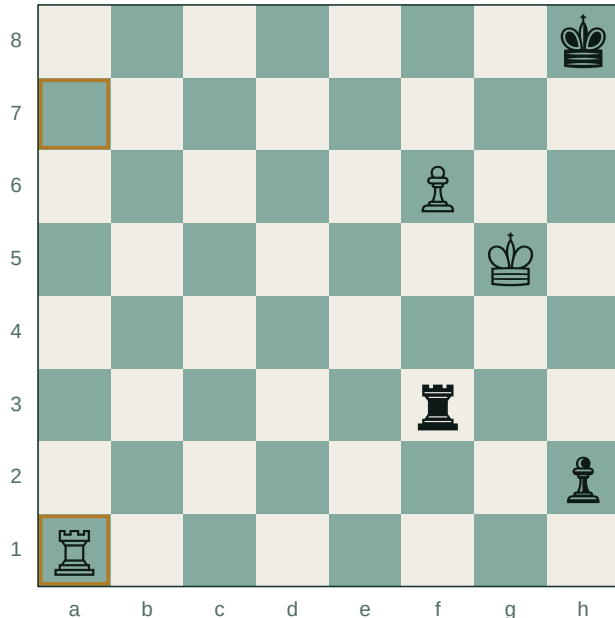


Rook-ending tactics: Black, move 67

Rook-ending tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 67.Ra1. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

67...Rg3+ 68. Kf4 Rg1 69. f7 Kg7 70. f8=Q+ Kxf8

67...Rg3+ Check restricts White to 5 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **68.Kf4**.

68...Rg1 The rook moves from g3 to g1. Recorded reply: **69.f7**.

69...Kg7 The king moves from h8 to g7. Recorded reply: **70.f8=Q+**.

70...Kxf8 The king captures the queen on f8.

At the end, nominal material is White 5 / Black 6 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +1:** the balance goes from +0 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A routine rook placement can miss a skewer or promotion with check. Let concrete tactics override a guideline when they conflict.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Rook endings combine pawn races with checks, cutoffs, and promotion tactics. Activity is vital, but the exact move order often decides whether a pawn can advance safely.

HOW TO LOOK

Check the kings' exposure, the rooks' checking distance, and the passed pawns. Calculate forcing checks before applying a general rook-ending rule.

The defending king is on g5. Geometrically undefended: rook on a1. Check for tactical protection.